HOLD PERSON (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

Level 2 – Enchantment
Casting Time: Action · Range: 60 feet
Components: V, S, M (a small, straight piece of iron) · Duration: Concentration, up to 1 minute
Classes: Bard, Cleric, Druid, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Choose a **Humanoid** that you can see within range. The target must succeed on a **Wisdom saving throw** or have the **Paralyzed** condition for the duration. At the end of each of its turns, it repeats the save, ending the spell on itself on a success.

Higher-level slot: you can target one additional Humanoid for each slot level above 2. The Humanoids must be within 30 feet of each other when you target them.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You choose a visible Humanoid within 60 ft.
2. Wisdom save against your spell save DC.
3. Failure: Paralyzed until it succeeds on a save at the end of one of its turns.
4. Concentration, 1 minute.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The text doesn't say whether damage allows a new save: only the end-of-turn save frees the target. Fix: stick to the text, or announce an option before the game.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe a chill freezing the limbs, a suddenly rigid posture, a fixed stare.

Step 1 – Choose a Humanoid:

Visible, within 60 ft. The spell works only on a Humanoid.

Step 2 – Wisdom save:

The target makes a Wisdom save against your spell save DC.

Step 3 – Failure: Paralyzed:

The target is **Paralyzed** (see the condition) for the duration.

Step 4 – New saves:

At the end of each of its turns, it repeats the Wisdom save. Success: the spell ends for it.

Example: Sélène (DC 14) casts Hold Person on a guard. Wisdom 8 against 14: a failure, he is Paralyzed. An ally strikes him in melee: the attack has Advantage, and a hit within 5 ft is a Critical Hit.

HOLD PERSON (5E, 2024 RULES) – Q&A AND DEBATE

⚠ Common questions:

How long does it last?
Concentration, up to 1 minute.

Which targets?
Humanoids only.

How does the target break free?
By succeeding on a Wisdom save at the end of one of its turns.

What does Paralyzed do?
Incapacitated, automatically fails Strength and Dexterity saves, Advantage against it, Critical Hit within 5 ft (see the condition).

Can I target several Humanoids?
Yes, with a level 3 or higher slot.

Does damage free the target?
No: the text doesn't provide for it. Table rule

Which save?
Wisdom.

Must I see the target?
Yes.

⚠ Debate points and table options:
Table rule

What is a Humanoid?
The creature type must be "Humanoid". **Option**: follow the type in the stat block; or the DM rules on edge cases.

Damage and new save
The text gives no extra save when the target takes damage. **Option**: follow the text.

Critical Hits
A Paralyzed creature takes Critical Hits within 5 ft. **Option**: keep it; or clearly announce the rule before combat.

Multiple targets
The Humanoids must be within 30 ft of each other. **Option**: measure from the center.

Concentration
The caster can lose concentration. **Option**: the spell ends immediately.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Readied Dispel
A readied *Dispel Magic* can't prevent the spell: it can only end it after it has taken effect (for example on an ally already held).

Readied spell
A readied spell spends its slot when readied: if the trigger doesn't happen, the slot is lost. The target must be in range when the trigger occurs.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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